

CADWELL REALTY GROUP

Albany, Oregon Real Estate

Albany Home Seller's Prep Guide

What to do in the 60 days before you list — so you net more and sell faster

60 DAYS OUT — STRATEGY

- Schedule a no-obligation CMA with Jason Cadwell to understand your current market value
- Review your mortgage payoff balance so you know your equity position
- Decide on your target list date and closing timeline
- Research comparable active listings in your neighborhood — these are your competition
- Begin decluttering: storage units are worth the cost for serious sellers
- Identify any deferred maintenance items that will show up on a buyer's inspection

45 DAYS OUT — REPAIRS & UPDATES

High-ROI improvements to complete before listing:

- Interior paint (neutral tones) — typical cost \$1,500–\$3,000, perceived value gain \$5,000–\$10,000
- Carpet cleaning or replacement — cost \$800–\$2,500
- Light fixture updates throughout — cost \$500–\$1,500
- Landscaping refresh: mulch, trimmed hedges, clean beds — cost \$300–\$800
- Pressure-wash driveway and exterior — cost \$200–\$400
- Replace dated hardware on cabinets and doors — cost \$200–\$600

Deferred maintenance to address (will appear in buyer's inspection):

- Roof condition — document recent repairs or remaining life
- Water heater age (replace if 12+ years old)
- HVAC service — get it serviced and keep the receipt
- Crawlspace moisture — inspect and remediate if needed
- Electrical issues — address any known panel or outlet problems

30 DAYS OUT — PRESENTATION

- Deep clean entire home including windows, baseboards, and appliances
- Depersonalize: remove family photos, personal collections, and excess furniture
- Stage key rooms: living room, primary bedroom, kitchen
- Address curb appeal: fresh mulch, trimmed lawn, clean front door, house numbers visible
- Replace any burned-out bulbs — every light should be on for showings
- Schedule professional photography (non-negotiable in Albany's 2026 market)
- Schedule drone photography if home has notable lot, view, or location

LAUNCH WEEK — CHECKLIST

- Confirm list price with your agent based on final CMA
- Review all listing details for accuracy before going live
- Plan to be out of home during all showings
- Schedule open house for first weekend on market
- Prepare disclosure forms (Oregon requires comprehensive seller disclosure)
- Monitor showing feedback daily with your agent
- Evaluate offer activity at Day 7 — if quiet, discuss pricing with agent

WHAT BUYERS WILL EVALUATE

- First impression: curb appeal and front door — buyers decide in 8 seconds
- Smell: no pet odors, smoke, or heavy air fresheners — clean neutral scent only
- Light: bright, well-lit rooms photograph and show better
- Space: decluttered homes feel 20% larger than cluttered ones
- Condition: buyers discount heavily for deferred maintenance they can see

NET PROCEEDS REMINDER: On a \$440,000 Albany sale, typical seller costs (commission + title + escrow + proration) run \$33,000–\$40,000. Know your number before you accept any offer. Jason provides a net sheet with every CMA — call (541) 619-4303.

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